User Research Consent Form

Project: Sift — NYC Event Discovery App **Researcher:** J Combinator Team, Columbia University — Startup Studio **Session type:** Usability test (~20–30 minutes) **Compensation:** None — we genuinely appreciate your time and feedback

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What This Is

You're being invited to participate in a brief usability test of **Sift**, a student project at Columbia University. Sift is an NYC event discovery app — you answer 3 questions about what you're in the mood for and get a short list of things worth doing this weekend.

You'll be asked to use the product and share your thoughts as you go. There are no right or wrong answers — we're testing the product, not you.

This is a class project, not a commercial product or academic research study.

What You'll Do

- Use Sift (siftapp.site) for approximately 20–30 minutes
- Think out loud as you go (we'll explain how before we start)
- Answer a few short questions after the session

How Your Feedback Will Be Used

- Notes from this session will be used only within the Columbia Startup Studio class to improve the product
- No personal identifying information will be stored or shared outside the team
- Your name will not appear in any class materials

Recording (check one)

☐ I **consent** to have this session recorded (audio/video) for internal review only. The recording will not be shared publicly or outside the team.

☐ I **do not consent** to recording. Notes only.

Your Rights

- You can stop the session at any time, for any reason, without penalty
- You can decline to answer any question

Agreement

By signing below, you confirm that you have read and understood the above, and agree to participate in this session.

Participant Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Researcher Name: _____

Team: J Combinator

Contact Email: _____

Questions? Reach out to the researcher at the email above.